

Chicago Tribune



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BREAKING NEWS AT CHICAGOTRIBUNE.COM

Effort to arrest Texans mounts

GOP asks Ill. court to enforce warrant against Democrats

By Rick Pearson, Jeremy Gorner and Dan Petrella
 Chicago Tribune

In what at least one legal expert called long shot litigation, Texas Republican Attorney General Ken Paxton and Illinois state Sen. Jil Tracy said Friday they asked a court in downstate Quincy to compel Illinois law enforcement to enforce civil warrants issued by the speaker of the Texas House against Democrats who fled their state.

Tracy, a veteran Republican lawmaker from Quincy, said she was deputized by Paxton as an uncompensated assistant Texas attorney general. She electronically filed the petition in Adams County Circuit Court, and said she thinks the Texas Democratic legislators “neglected their duty” by leaving their state weeks after they began a special session.

“It’s our job. You may not like the map. You may not like a bill. You vote ‘no.’ And you do your job. And you work to express your opinion and those of your constituents at the same time as to why you support or do not support a bill,” said Tracy, who has served on and off in the Illinois General Assembly since 2006. “But you have a duty under your oath of office.”

By filing the petition in Adams County in rural west central Illinois along the Mississippi River, Republicans may be looking for a more conservative court to try to make their case, rather than filing it in the Chicago suburban region where the House Democrats have relocated.

For a second day, their heavily secured St. Charles hotel was the subject of a bomb

Turn to Texans, Page 4



A person walks to an entrance of Weiss Memorial Hospital in Chicago’s Uptown neighborhood on Friday. DOMINIC DI PALERMO/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Weiss on life support

Uptown hospital to remain closed while parent company appeals Medicare cut

WEST SUBURBAN MEDICAL AT RISK:
 Without additional funding, West Suburban Medical Center in Oak Park, which is owned by the same company that operates Weiss Memorial Hospital in Uptown, could face the same fate. West Suburban, which has 1,000 employees, is hiring some Weiss workers during the Medicare appeal process, but not all will be able to make the commute.

By Robert McCoppin and Talia Soglin | Chicago Tribune

Weiss Memorial Hospital in Chicago, which had been scheduled to lose Medicare funding Saturday, ceased most of its operations Friday, officials confirmed. They also warned that without additional funding, West Suburban Medical Center in Oak Park could face the same fate.

Resilience Healthcare, which operates both facilities, plans to appeal to federal authorities to restore Medicaid and Medicare funding for Weiss so that it can reopen, CEO Dr. Manoj Prasad said during an Oak Park news conference, but the process may take a year or longer.

In the meantime, Prasad committed to continuing to operate West Suburban Medical Center — but said it, too, could face closure. “Any hospital can do that, I hate to say, with the environment that has changed,” he said.

Inpatient care at Weiss, including surgeries and the emergency room, ended Friday, but outpatient care and doctors’ offices will remain open. A notice on the Weiss website said the medical records department remains open, and listed a phone number for patients seeking copies of records to call.

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“The closing ... is what happens when private equity treats poor people as disposable and when healthcare is treated as a way to make profit, instead of providing access to quality care for people.”

— Ald. Angela Clay, 46th, in a statement

JAMES LOVELL 1928-2025



A ‘pillar of space flight’

Astronaut on crew of Apollo 13 mission beset by tank explosion ran restaurant in Lake Forest after retiring from NASA program

By Don Babwin
 Associated Press

CHICAGO — James Lovell, the commander of Apollo 13 who helped turn a failed moon mission into a triumph of on-the-fly can-do engineering, has died. He was 97.

Lovell died Thursday in Lake Forest, NASA said Friday.

“Jim’s character and steadfast courage helped our nation reach the Moon and turned a potential tragedy into a success from which

Apollo 13 commander James Lovell at the Shoot for the Moon exhibition at Chicago’s Adler Planetarium in 2010. Lovell died Thursday in Lake Forest, where he lived, at age 97. E. JASON WAMBSGANS/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

we learned an enormous amount,” NASA said. “We mourn his passing even as we celebrate his achievements.”

One of NASA’s most traveled astronauts in the agency’s first decade, Lovell flew four times — Gemini 7, Gemini 12, Apollo 8 and Apollo 13 — with the two Apollo flights riveting the folks on Earth.

In 1968, the Apollo 8 crew of Lovell, Frank Borman and William

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In suburbs, Noem blasts Ill. immigration policies

Her message of ‘fear’ condemned by locals who vow to continue to inform immigrants of rights

By Laura Rodríguez Presa, Madeline Buckley and Olivia Olander
 Chicago Tribune

U.S. Homeland Security Secretary Kristi Noem used a visit to the Chicago area on Friday to criticize Illinois politicians, blasting Gov. JB Pritzker and Mayor Brandon Johnson over state policies that limit local cooperation with federal immigration authorities, even as locals vowed to step up efforts to confront overly aggressive enforcement tactics.

Noem’s message to Chicagoans was met with swift condemnation from community groups and local politicians who promised to continue to educate immigrant communities about their rights, arguing that the secretary’s goal was simply to stoke more fear.

“In carrying out this campaign of fear and division the federal administration has repeat-

edly violated the Constitution, denied people due process, and separated hardworking families who are integral to our neighborhoods,” Johnson’s office said in a statement. “What Secretary Noem’s DHS is doing is not accountability. It’s mass targeting, fearmongering, and it undermines our work to ensure every Chicagoan can feel safe in our city.”

As about three dozen people protested outside, Noem spoke to the media at a Lombard field office, relaying oft-repeated talking points about immigration enforcement priorities for President Donald Trump, who came into office with sweeping promises to hit record-level arrests and deportations.

Though arrests and deportations have increased since Trump took office, the numbers have fallen short of the stated

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‘NOT WELCOME IN THIS CITY’: Protesters disrupt U.S. Department of Homeland Security job fair in downtown Chicago on Thursday that was meant to recruit agents. **Chicagoland, Page 3**

TODAY’S WEATHER High **93** Low **75**
 Complete Chicagoland forecast on Page 22

\$4.00 city and suburbs and elsewhere
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